

CRIME INVESTIGATION - SUSPECT PROFILES

Case Reference: HBL-2026-KD-0074

Total Suspects: 12

Each suspect profile begins with 'SUSPECT: Name' as required by the Crime Investigation DSS.

SUSPECT: Sanjay Patil

Sanjay Patil, age 39. Former accountant of Kulkarni Agencies dismissed weeks before the kidnapping for embezzling Rs. 9 lakh. Knew the victim's cash collection routine and evening schedule. Threatened the victim after his dismissal, saying he would regret it. Paid Rs. 1.5 lakh in advance rent to the farmhouse owner three weeks earlier. Phone records show contact with Ganesh Shinde. No alibi; says he was at home, but no witness. Prior police complaint for cheating in 2020. Strong motive and inside knowledge.

SUSPECT: Ganesh Shinde

Ganesh Shinde, age 45, known as Gani. Gang leader with a criminal record including extortion, two arrests for kidnapping for ransom, and an ongoing case under the Arms Act. Tower data places his phone near Kalghatgi during the ransom calls. Part of the ransom was deposited into his cousin's account. Fled his home after the rescue. Absconding, with a warrant issued. Believed to have organised the abduction team.

SUSPECT: Yusuf Sait

Yusuf Sait, age 34. Driver with a prior conviction for vehicle theft. Fingerprints matching his were lifted from the Tempo Traveller. Was seen near Hubballi railway station on 15 August, when the vehicle was stolen. Says he was in Belagavi visiting family; his sister says he came home only the next morning. Owes money to Ganesh Shinde. Arrested and in custody.

SUSPECT: Prakash Jadhav

Prakash Jadhav, age 50. Private financier who lent the victim Rs. 25 lakh at high interest. Made threats over delayed repayment and had visited the victim's office twice. Denies involvement and says he only wanted repayment. Phone records show no contact with the gang. Was at a wedding function in Dharwad with over 100 guests on the evening of the abduction. Lender known to police for illegal recovery methods but never convicted.

SUSPECT: Vithal Naik

Vithal Naik, age 41. Head constable posted at the local police station. His phone number appears in call logs with a gang member twice on the day of the kidnapping. Claims the calls

were with an informer about an unrelated case. Cannot produce any case record supporting this. Was on duty at the station that evening, per the duty register, but the register was signed later. Departmental action pending.

SUSPECT: Shivanand Hosamani

Shivanand Hosamani, age 57. Owner of the farmhouse near Kalghatgi where the victim was held. Received Rs. 1.5 lakh in cash as advance rent three weeks earlier from Sanjay Patil. Says he believed the house was to be used for a family event. Was at his village during the holding period. No criminal record. Behaviour on being questioned was evasive.

SUSPECT: Ashok Bhat

Ashok Bhat, age 33. Warehouse security guard who left his post for 30 minutes at the critical time after a call from someone claiming to be the supervisor. The camera controller was switched off during this period. Says he was deceived. Phone records show the caller used an unregistered SIM. No financial irregularities. No criminal record. May have been used unknowingly.

SUSPECT: Amit Kulkarni

Amit Kulkarni, age 47. Younger brother of the victim and party to a bitter dispute over the family property. Made statements that his brother 'deserves to be taught a lesson' at a family meeting. Was at his own shop in Gadag until late evening, per the neighbouring shopkeepers and the shop's CCTV. Contributed Rs. 15 lakh toward the ransom and has cooperated. No criminal record.

SUSPECT: Latha Hiremath

Latha Hiremath, age 30. Personal assistant to the victim who circulated the daily schedule to staff and outside contacts. Passed the schedule to Sanjay Patil's wife as a courtesy without realizing the risk. Phone records show no contact with the gang. No financial links. No criminal record. Has cooperated fully and volunteered her communications.

SUSPECT: Mohan Desai

Mohan Desai, age 55. Business rival who threatened the victim after losing a supply contract, telling him he would 'finish him' in the market. This remains a business threat. Was exhibiting at an agricultural fair in Pune during the kidnapping; organiser records, photographs and multiple exhibitors verify his presence. No criminal record. No links to the gang.

SUSPECT: Rohini Kulkarni

Rohini Kulkarni, age 48. Wife of the victim who received the ransom calls, reported the matter to police and negotiated the payment. Was at home with relatives throughout. No financial

motive. Has cooperated fully and handed over her phone. No criminal record. Alibi confirmed by family members and phone location.

SUSPECT: Deepti Nadkarni

Deepti Nadkarni, age 44. Family advocate who advised on police involvement and negotiations. Professional role only. Was in court in Dharwad on the day of the abduction, confirmed by court records. No connection to any suspect. No criminal record. Cooperating.